SANAD · UX SPECIFICATION · V1.0

Client Portal
بوابة الموكل

The Client Experience Layer for Law Firms

A screen-by-screen specification for the Sanad client portal — the surface where a law firm's customer sees case status in plain Arabic, reviews and signs documents, pays ZATCA-compliant invoices, and reaches the office without phone calls. Passwordless, mobile-first, RTL-native, and designed for users who have never used legal software before.

8 SCREENS | PASSWORDLESS | RTL-FIRST | MVP SCOPED

Sanad Product Team — فريق سند

Companion to the Sanad Product Roadmap · Feature F-07–F-09

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SECTION 01

Portal Overview & Design Principles

The client portal is Sanad's sharpest competitive wedge. Every stakeholder in the legal relationship except the client already has software; the client has phone calls. When a firm runs its matters on Sanad, inviting a client to the portal takes one click — and from that moment the client stops asking "where does my case stand?" because the answer is always on their phone. For the firm this means fewer interruptions, faster document turnaround, quicker invoice settlement, and a visibly modern brand. For Sanad it means the platform becomes the communication layer of the relationship, not just the lawyer's internal tool.

The portal is deliberately **not** a scaled-down copy of the lawyer workspace. Its users did not choose legal work and must not be asked to learn legal vocabulary, manage passwords, or interpret statuses. Everything below — information architecture, wording, wireframes, and acceptance criteria — follows five principles that resolve nearly every design question this document raises.

01

Zero Jargon — لغة بسيطة

Every status and event is written in plain spoken Arabic. Legal terms appear only when mapped through the glossary in Section 05. If a phrase needs a lawyer to explain it, it ships again.

02

Passwordless — بدون كلمة مرور

Access is a magic link plus a one-time code sent by SMS or email. No resets, no recovery questions, no stored passwords — the single biggest usability decision in this spec.

03

Mobile-First RTL

Designed at 360px width in Arabic before desktop exists. Clients arrive from a WhatsApp link on a phone; desktop is a convenience, not the target.

04

Proactive, Not Reactive

The portal must answer questions before they are asked: what happens next, what is required from me, what is due. If a client must call to learn status, the portal has failed.

05

Trust by Default

Data shown is scoped to the client's own matters, consent is explicit per PDPPL, and every sensitive action (signing, payment) confirms identity with a fresh code.

Out of scope for MVP: client-to-client features, self-service new-matter intake, direct legal advice through chat (messaging is logistics, not consultation), and any payment flow where Sanad holds funds — payments route through the firm's own gateway. Keeping

MVP scope honest is what allows the success metrics in Section 05 to be met rather than diluted.

SECTION 02

Client Journey & Access Model

The client journey has one moment of truth — the first magic link — and one habit loop — checking the portal when a notification arrives. Everything in between must be frictionless enough that a client with modest digital literacy succeeds on the first try, ideally within a minute of receiving the invitation. The five stages below define that path; the screens in Sections 03–04 hang directly off stages two through four.

STAGE 1
Invite
Lawyer adds the client to a matter; the portal sends an SMS or email invitation with a magic link.

STAGE 2
Activate
Client opens the link, verifies with a one-time code, and lands directly on their case — S1, then S2.

STAGE 3
Daily loop
Notifications pull the client in: new document to review, upcoming session, invoice due — each opens the exact screen.

STAGE 4
Act
The client approves, signs, pays, or messages — every action completes on the phone without a visit to the office.

STAGE 5
Advocate
A client who always knows what is happening recommends the firm — and mentions the "app the firm uses."

MAGIC-LINK AUTHENTICATION FLOW

1. **Invite dispatch.** The lawyer enters a mobile number and/or email per client. Sanad sends a message in Arabic: "لديك دعوة من مكتب [اسم المكتب] لمتابعة قضيتك — اضغط الرابط" with a tokenized link valid for 72 hours.
2. **Link open.** The link opens S1 with the client's name and firm pre-shown. The token is single-use and device-agnostic; opening it on a new device is fine.
3. **One-time code.** A 6-digit code is sent to the same channel; the client types it once. Code expires in 10 minutes; three failed attempts lock the flow for 15 minutes with a clear Arabic message and a resend option.
4. **Session issued.** Success grants a 24-hour session; the device is remembered for 30 days so return visits open the portal directly. A second login within the window never requires a new code.
5. **Re-entry.** After 30 days — or on a new device — the client requests a fresh code from the login screen using their mobile number. No password exists anywhere in the system.

> **Device sharing is expected.** Family members often share a phone. The portal therefore never stores sensitive data in local cache beyond the session, shows only one client's matters at a time, and offers an explicit "تسجيل الخروج" on shared-device suspicion. Sessions also require a fresh code for any signing or payment action regardless of remembered status.

PDPPL posture. The invitation message doubles as the consent surface: it states what data the client will see, that the firm controls that data, and that the client can request deletion at any time from Settings (S8). Consent is recorded with timestamp, channel, and message version. Every personal-data field rendered in the portal is enumerated in Sanad's data map, and client-initiated deletion requests route to the firm as a workflow item rather than silently destroying matter records the firm legally retains.

Session rule	Value	Rationale
Magic-link validity	72 hours	Long enough for a busy client, short enough to be safe; re-request is one tap.
OTP validity	10 minutes, 3 attempts	Standard banking-grade tolerance; lockout prevents brute force.
Session length	24 hours active	Matches "check once a day" usage pattern without nagging.
Device memory	30 days	Removes friction from the weekly-return habit that drives WAU.
Step-up auth	Fresh OTP for sign & pay	Sensitive actions always re-verify identity, even on remembered devices.

SECTION 03

Screen Specifications — S1 to S4

Each screen below carries a wireframe, its key elements, the states it must handle, and acceptance criteria written for test cases. Wireframes are intentionally low-fidelity: they fix structure, hierarchy, and wording — visual polish belongs to the design system, not this document. Arabic labels shown are the actual strings to implement; English annotations describe the element role.



S1 — MAGIC-LINK ACTIVATION



S2 — HOME DASHBOARD

S1 Magic-Link Activation

تفعيل الدعوة

KEY ELEMENTS

- Sanad brand mark, welcome line naming the client and the firm, masked channel confirmation (phone digits or email).
- Primary action "إرسال رمز التحقق"; secondary text link "لم يصلك الرابط؟ أعد الإرسال".
- Inline consent line (PDPPL) with link to the firm's privacy summary — no checkbox wall, single line.

STATES

- **Expired link:** friendly screen "انتهت صلاحية الرابط" with one-tap re-request to the same channel.
- **Wrong/locked OTP:** attempts remaining shown; after 3 failures, 15-minute lock with countdown.
- **Already active:** deep-links straight into S2 on a remembered device, skipping the ceremony.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- First activation completes in under 60 seconds on a 4G phone; measured and logged as TTA (time-to-activate).
- All states render fully in Arabic RTL; no English system strings anywhere in the flow.
- Consent record persisted with message version before any matter data renders.

S2 Home Dashboard

الرئيسية

KEY ELEMENTS

- Greeting with first name; one card per matter: matter label (client-friendly name, not case number first), one-line status phrase, next event date, pending-action chips.
- Action-first ordering: matters needing the client's action float to the top with a distinct chip ("ينتظر موافقتك").
- Invoice badge card when anything is due; bottom tab bar with 5 destinations (الرئيسية، قضاياي، المستندات، الفواتير، أكثر).

STATES

- **Empty (no matters yet):** illustration + "سيظهر هنا كل ما يتعلق بقضيتك بمجرد أن يضيفها مكتبك."
- **Multiple matters:** cards sorted by pending-action first, then next-event date; never a scroll of raw case numbers.
- **Stale data:** pull-to-refresh with last-updated caption; no infinite spinners.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Home renders a meaningful answer to "what is happening with my case?" in one screen with zero taps.
- Any pending action deep-links directly to its screen (S5 document, S6 invoice) — never to a generic list.
- Status phrases come only from the glossary-approved set (Section 05); no free-text statuses in MVP.



S3 — CASE TIMELINE



S4 — SESSIONS & APPOINTMENTS

S3 Case Timeline

قضاياي — التفاصيل

KEY ELEMENTS

- Matter header: friendly matter name, court, matter type; vertical timeline with past events (muted), current event (accent), and a permanent "ما المطلوب مني؟" card pinned at the bottom.
- Every event carries a one-line plain-Arabic explanation under its title — the explanation is mandatory, not decorative.
- No internal notes, no strategy remarks, no opposing-party details: only firm-approved event types render client-side.

STATES

- **Long-paused matter:** monthly automated status keeps the timeline honest ("لا جديد هذا الشهر — القضية بانتظار جدولة المحكمة").
- **Closed matter:** timeline ends with outcome card and a "شكراً لثقتك" closure note with firm contact.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Client can answer "what happened, what is next, what is required from me" in under 10 seconds of reading.
- Event vocabulary passes the jargon review; court names render as the client's court writes them.
- Timeline loads with the last 3 events above the fold on a 360px screen.

S4 Sessions & Appointments

الجلسات والمواعيد

KEY ELEMENTS

- Next-session card with oversized date and time, court name, room/district when known, and two actions: add-to-calendar (ICS) and directions (map deep link).
- An explicit expectation line: whether the client's attendance is required — sourced from the matter data, never guessed.
- Past sessions collapse into one-line summaries; tapping expands the plain-Arabic outcome note.

STATES

- **No sessions scheduled:** quiet empty state — "لا توجد جلسات مجدولة حالياً" with a note that any scheduling notifies them immediately.
- **Session moved/postponed:** old card struck through, new card highlighted, push+SMS notification sent the moment the lawyer updates it.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Calendar files open correctly in iOS Calendar, Google Calendar, and Outlook (test matrix in QA plan).
- Postponement updates reach the client within 60 seconds of the lawyer saving the change.
- Hijri date shown alongside Gregorian on every date, consistent with the platform convention.

SECTION 04

Screen Specifications — S5 to S8



S5 — DOCUMENTS REVIEW & E-SIGN



S6 — ZATCA INVOICES & PAYMENT

S5 Document Review & E-Signature

المستندات

KEY ELEMENTS

- Document list grouped by matter with status chips: بانتظار مراجعتك / للتعليق / موقّع / للاطلاع.
- Review view: paginated PDF with pinch-zoom, page indicator, two actions — "موافقة" and "إضافة تعليق" (comment anchored to a page, one thread per page).
- Signing flow: read-through confirmation (client must reach the last page), fresh OTP, typed legal name, then a stamped "موقّع إلكترونياً" banner with timestamp; audit record captures device and IP.
- Download always available; signed copies are immutable versions, never overwritten.

STATES

- **New version sent after comments:** previous thread archived and shown read-only; client re-reviews the new version from page one.
- **Signing interrupted:** progress saved; resume prompts a fresh OTP (step-up auth rule).
- **Accessibility:** PDFs that fail text-extraction are flagged to the lawyer at send time with a hint to attach an accessible version.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Median time from "sent for review" to client action under 24 hours (KPI from the roadmap).
- No document can be signed without reaching the final page and completing a fresh OTP — verified by test case.
- Comment threads never leave the firm boundary; they appear in the lawyer's workspace in real time.

S6 ZATCA Invoices & Payment

الفواتير

KEY ELEMENTS

- Invoice cards with number, amount (VAT-inclusive stated explicitly), issue date, due chip; the ZATCA QR is viewable full-screen for verification.
- "دفع الآن" opens the firm's payment gateway with amount and reference pre-filled — Mada, Apple Pay, and cards; Sanad never holds funds.
- Paid invoices keep their receipt one tap away; overdue items escalate wording politely ("يرجى تسديد الفاتورة") and never threaten.
- A compliance footnote states invoices are issued electronically in accordance with ZATCA e-invoicing requirements.

STATES

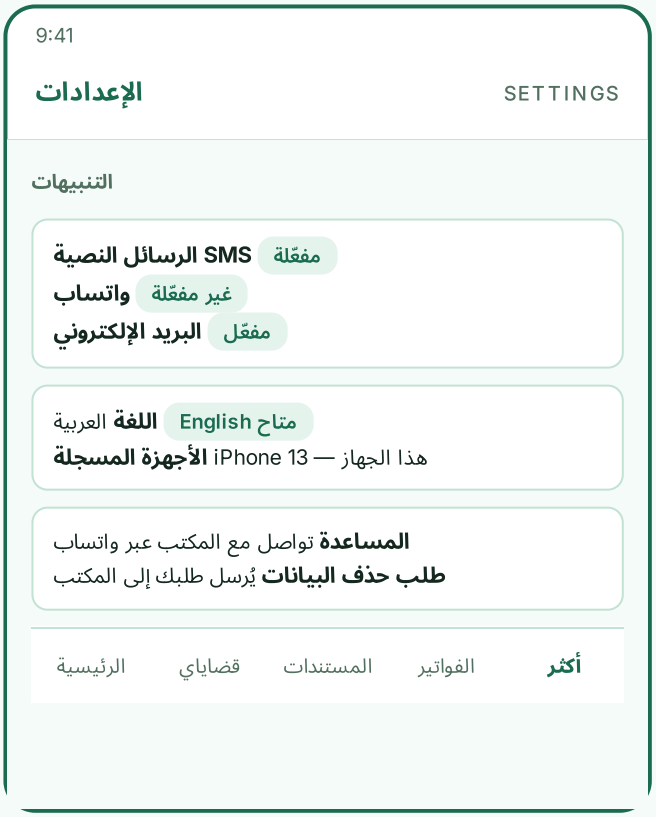
- **Payment pending:** after gateway redirect, a "جارٍ تأكيد الدفع" state reconciles idempotently; double-press cannot double-charge.
- **Payment failed:** plain reason ("رصيد غير كافٍ — حاول بطاقة أخرى") with retry; the failure never mutates the invoice.
- **Partial payments / credit notes:** running balance line "المتبقي: X ر.س" instead of a confusing ledger.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Days-to-payment KPI tracked per invoice from delivery to settlement; target is a 50% reduction vs pre-portal baseline.
- Every payment produces exactly one receipt, archived to both the client portal and the firm ledger.
- Invoice PDF matches ZATCA field requirements and re-downloads identically at any later date.



S7 — SECURE MESSAGES WITH THE OFFICE



S8 — NOTIFICATIONS & SETTINGS

S7 Secure Messages

الرسائل

KEY ELEMENTS

- One thread per matter with the office (not a personal lawyer identity — the firm is the counterparty, so absences never strand the client).
- Three quick-reply templates cover the majority of traffic: thanks/follow-up, reschedule request, question-about-appointment.
- Pinned expectation note: messages are for logistics, not legal consultation; typical response within one business day.
- Attachments limited to images and PDFs up to 10MB; large evidence files go through the office, not chat.

STATES

- **Office away:** auto-note with expected response window set by the firm ("المكتب في إجازة حتى 20 يناير").
- **Client writes during sign:** message thread never blocks document actions; both are independent surfaces.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Messages are visible to the firm's authorized roles and auditable; no private lawyer-client channel outside firm governance.
- Notification for every new message reuses the unified notification bus (roadmap F-12) with client-appropriate wording.
- A client can reach a human within one business day for any message — measured as first-response time.

S8 Notifications & Settings

الإعدادات

KEY ELEMENTS

- Channel matrix (SMS, WhatsApp, email) with per-channel on/off and a quiet-hours default honoring 9 PM–8 AM Asia/Riyadh for non-critical notices.
- Language switch AR/EN (MVP ships Arabic-complete; English is a stretched goal but the toggle is designed in from day one).
- Registered devices list with "this device" marker and one-tap sign-out of all devices.
- Help entry (WhatsApp deep link to the office) and PDPPL data-deletion request that opens a tracked workflow at the firm.

STATES

- **WhatsApp never approved by client:** SMS remains the guaranteed channel; the matrix makes the fallback visible rather than assumed.
- **Deletion request filed:** confirmation screen explains the firm reviews the request and what legally must be retained.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Changing any setting takes effect on the next notification dispatch, verified end-to-end in staging.
- Sign-out-all revokes portal sessions within 60 seconds across devices.
- Every setting screen is operable one-handed; no control sits above the reachable thumb zone on first screens.

SECTION 05

Content Rules, Edge Cases & MVP Scope

Language is the portal's core interface, so wording is governed, not improvised. Every status, event title, and notification must come from the approved glossary below or pass a review against it. The mapping direction is always the same: legal precision stays in the lawyer workspace; the client sees the consequence. This table is also the seed of the in-app glossary tooltips, so a curious client can always tap through to the precise meaning.

Legal term (internal)	Client wording (portal)	Why
الجلسة	موعدك أمام القاضي	Says what it is and what happens, not the procedural label.
المدة النظامية	موعد نهائي قانوني لا يمكن تجاوزه	Communicates gravity without the statutory vocabulary.
المذكرة	وثيقة قانونية أعدّها محاميك	Describes origin and role instead of the genre name.
حكم ابتدائي	قرار المحكمة الأول في قضيتك	Ordinal phrasing beats the procedural adjective.
اعتراض	طلب إعادة النظر في القرار	Everyday verb phrase; keeps the client's mental model correct.
إحالة	تحويل قضيتك إلى الجهة المختصة	Focuses on movement and competence, not the docket term.
أتعاب المحامي	رسوم الخدمة القانونية	Aligns with what the client believes they are paying.
قيد الإجراء	قضيتك مستمرة — لا يوجد مطلوب منك حالياً	The most common status deserves the most reassuring phrasing.

NOTIFICATION RULES

Event	Priority	Channels	Timing & tone
Document awaiting your approval	Critical	SMS + push + in-app	Immediately; action-first wording with a deep link.
Session scheduled or moved	Critical	SMS + push + in-app	Within 60 seconds of the lawyer saving; neutral, factual.
Invoice due within 5 days	Update	SMS + in-app	Once at T-5, once at T-1; polite, never threatening.
New timeline event	Update	Push + in-app	Immediately; one line, tap for context.
Monthly "no news" status	FYI	In-app only	Auto on the 1st; keeps the timeline honest without noise.
Message from the office	Update	Chosen channel + in-app	Immediately; shows office name, not a raw phone number.

Accessibility and inclusion. The portal targets WCAG 2.1 AA: contrast at least 4.5:1 for body text, touch targets at least 44×44px, pinch-zoom never disabled (a lesson already learned from the platform audit), and every input programmatically labeled for screen readers — the exact failure found on the main platform's login form must not be reproduced here. Iconography always pairs with Arabic text labels for low-literacy users, color never carries meaning alone (status chips include words), and all layouts survive 200% zoom without horizontal scrolling.

Edge cases register. The states below are written once here and referenced by every screen spec: shared family device (step-up OTP for sensitive actions, easy sign-out); client without a smartphone (firm falls back to SMS summaries — the portal is never a condition of service); intermittent connectivity (actions queue locally and sync, with a visible pending marker); expired magic link (one-tap re-request); lawyer on leave (office-level thread and auto-note keep responses alive); client disputes a status wording (firm can append a correction note that renders on the timeline, preserving trust through transparency).

MVP SCOPE BY SCREEN

Screen	In MVP	Deferred
S1 Activation	Magic link + OTP, re-request, consent capture	Biometric login
S2 Home	Matter cards, action chips, invoice badge	Customizable widgets
S3 Timeline	Event feed with glossary wording, required-of-me card	Media attachments on events
S4 Sessions	Next-session card, ICS, directions, history	Client-proposed appointments
S5 Documents	List, review, comments, OTP e-sign, immutable versions	Batch signing, Arabic PDF generation
S6 Invoices	List, ZATCA view, gateway payment, receipts	Stored payment methods, installments
S7 Messages	Per-matter thread, quick replies, attachments	Group threads, voice notes
S8 Settings	Channels, language toggle, devices, deletion request	Full English localization

Portal KPIs. Four numbers decide whether this portal earns its place: invite acceptance at or above 70% within 48 hours; monthly active clients at or above 50% of activated clients; median document approval under 24 hours; and median days-to-payment cut in half versus the pre-portal baseline. Each is computed from events the portal emits natively (invite_sent, client_activated, doc_actioned, invoice_settled), so the dashboard ships with the feature rather than after it.

- [ ] Validate glossary wording with five real clients of friendly firms before build — wording bugs are cheaper on paper.
- [ ] Build S1 and S2 first, dogfood with one firm's clients, then complete the remaining screens.
- [ ] Wire every notification through the unified bus with client wording from day one — retrofitting tone never works.
- [ ] Run the accessibility pass per screen at implementation time, not as a pre-launch cleanup.
- [ ] Review KPIs at weeks 2, 6, and 12 after launch; re-scope deferred items based on what clients actually use.

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The client always knows.

Eight screens, one promise: no client ever wonders where their case stands. This specification is ready for design handoff and sprint planning — next step is glossary validation with five real clients, then the S1/S2 build.

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